

PLE5054: COMMERCIAL WRITING AND DRAFTING

Effective Term

Semester A 2025/26

Part I Course Overview

Course Title

Commercial Writing and Drafting

Subject Code

PLE - Professional Legal Education

Course Number

5054

Academic Unit

School of Law (FL)

College/School

School of Law (FL)

Course Duration

One Semester

Credit Units

2

Level

P5, P6 - Postgraduate Degree

Medium of Instruction

English

Medium of Assessment

English

Prerequisites

Nil

Precursors

Nil

Equivalent Courses

Nil

Exclusive Courses

Nil

Part II Course Details

Abstract

This course aims to prepare students to write letters of advice and draft commercial agreements in plain English that address client needs.

Course Intended Learning Outcomes (CILOs)

CILOs		Weighting (if app.)	DEC-A1	DEC-A2	DEC-A3
1	Apply a problem-solving approach to resolving a client's issues including: - identifying client goals; - identifying legal issues; and - applying the law to the facts and recommending a solution.		x	x	x
2	Draft documents used in the practice of commercial law in plain English, such as: - correspondence, especially advising clients in connection with commercial transactions; - commercial documents.		x	x	x
3	Draft clauses as part of a commercial agreement in a new situation with or without the use of precedents.		x	x	x

A1: Attitude

Develop an attitude of discovery/innovation/creativity, as demonstrated by students possessing a strong sense of curiosity, asking questions actively, challenging assumptions or engaging in inquiry together with teachers.

A2: Ability

Develop the ability/skill needed to discover/innovate/create, as demonstrated by students possessing critical thinking skills to assess ideas, acquiring research skills, synthesizing knowledge across disciplines or applying academic knowledge to real-life problems.

A3: Accomplishments

Demonstrate accomplishment of discovery/innovation/creativity through producing /constructing creative works/new artefacts, effective solutions to real-life problems or new processes.

Learning and Teaching Activities (LTAs)

LTAs		Brief Description	CILO No.	Hours/week (if applicable)
1	1	Teaching and learning will primarily be based on problem solving activities and discussions in large and small groups involving: - dissecting fact patterns; - analyzing precedents; and - planning written output.	1	

2	2	Teaching and learning will primarily be based on interactive drafting activities in large and small groups involving: - analysis of drafting alternatives and current practices; - group discussions; - individual and group drafting activities; - two non-assessable exercises in which feedback is provided by the instructor; and - one voluntary conference with the instructor.	2	
3	3	Teaching and learning will primarily be based on an individual drafting activity and small group discussion.	3	

Assessment Tasks / Activities (ATs)

ATs		CILO No.	Weighting (%)	Remarks ("-" for nil entry)	Allow Use of GenAI?
1	Completion of exercises and satisfactory participation in tutorials	1, 2, 3	0	Compulsory	No

Continuous Assessment (%)

0

Examination (%)

100

Examination Duration (Hours)

3

Minimum Examination Passing Requirement (%)

50

Additional Information for ATs

Compulsory

The use of Generative AI tools is not allowed.

Assessment Rubrics (AR)**Assessment Task**

Final Examination

Criterion

To pass this course students must obtain a mark of 50%.

Excellent

(A+, A, A-) The work meets the client's needs in all respects, evidenced by -

- a superior grasp of the issues and subject matter
- good organization
- a capacity to analyze and synthesize
- possession of an extensive knowledge base
- a superior use of lawyer skills.

Good

(B+, B, B-) The work meets the client's needs in most respects, evidenced by -

- a strong grasp of the issues and subject matter
- some critical and analytical ability
- an understanding of the applicable law and procedures
- a good use of lawyer skills.

Fair

(C+, C, C-*) The work meets the client's main needs, evidenced by -

- an adequate grasp of the issues and subject matter
- an ability to develop solutions to the client's problems
- a basic use of lawyer skills.

Marginal

(D*)

Failure

(F) The work does not meet the client's needs, evidenced by little or an insufficient -

- grasp of the issues and subject matter
- critical and analytical ability
- understanding of the applicable law and procedures.

Additional Information for AR

*Note: The University's grades C- and D are not used in the PCLL.

Part III Other Information

Keyword Syllabus

- Plain English and Editing
- Problem Solving/Planning
- Drafting Correspondence
- Drafting Transactional and Commercial Documents

Reading List

Compulsory Readings

Title	
1	See Course Guide

Additional Readings

Title	
1	See Course Guide
2	Online English Resources

3	The English Language Centre link is: http://www.cityu.edu.hk/elc/
4	The Self-Access Centre link is: http://www.cityu.edu.hk/elc/SAC.html